

Green & Social Claims Risk Triage - Methodology Note

Hostable v34 | Indicative first-pass screening methodology for green and social claims

Purpose and scope

The tool screens company websites, product pages, brochures, sustainability pages, annual reports, ESG reports and selected governance documents for green and social claim risk. It is designed as a triage and claim-governance tool. It is not a legal opinion and does not determine that greenwashing or social washing has occurred.

Communication-channel distinction

The scan now distinguishes the source channel of the text reviewed. This distinction affects how the same wording is interpreted.

Channel	How the tool treats it
Client-facing / consumer-facing communication	Higher wording and substantiation burden. EmpCo-style scrutiny is directly relevant for green claims in websites, product pages, brochures, folders, campaigns and other market-facing material.
Investor / stakeholder reporting	Mainly used as substantiation and consistency evidence. Annual reports, ESG reports and sustainability reports may support claims but are not treated like consumer advertising unless the same wording is reused externally.
Policy / internal governance material	Used as governance and due-diligence evidence. Policies, codes and procedures can substantiate social or forced-labour claims but are not in themselves promotional consumer claims.
Mixed or unclear	Manual review recommended. Where a page combines marketing and reporting language, stricter controls are applied to statements likely to be seen by customers or end-users.

Green-claims lens

The green module is based on the logic of Directive (EU) 2024/825, often referred to as EmpCo, which strengthens EU consumer-protection rules for environmental claims. The tool pays particular attention to generic environmental claims, climate-neutrality or offsetting language, sustainability labels, comparative environmental claims, circularity/durability/recyclability claims and future environmental-performance claims.

Social-claims and forced-labour lens

The social module screens broad or sensitive social wording such as responsible sourcing, human rights, labour rights, diversity, inclusion, worker welfare, customer fairness, accessibility, community impact and supplier responsibility. It also adds a product/supply-chain lens inspired by Regulation (EU) 2024/3015 on products made with forced labour, especially for forced-labour-free, modern-slavery-free, traceability, supplier due-diligence, import/export or responsible-sourcing claims.

Risk scoring model

Green and social scores are calculated separately and then combined into a global score. The score is a prioritisation signal, not a finding.

Driver	Weight	Meaning
Claim wording risk	30%	Breadth, generic wording, absolute wording, prominence, sensitivity and whether the claim implies broad assurance.
Substantiation / evidence-gap risk	30%	Missing scope, KPIs, methodology, verification, limitations, audit coverage, remediation evidence, traceability or data quality.
External contradictory-context risk	25%	Negative public-source signals that may contradict or qualify the claim area, including regulator, NGO, media or legal signals.
Sector exposure	15%	Baseline exposure for sectors structurally more prone to greenwashing or social-washing allegations. Sector exposure never creates High risk on its own.

Sector exposure

Some sectors are more exposed because of consumer-facing claims, high environmental footprint, complex supply chains, labour-intensity, vulnerable customers, sensitive products or dependence on certification and labels. Examples include fashion and retail, food, finance, extractives, energy, transport, consumer goods, electronics and platform or labour-intensive services. The score treats sector exposure as contextual sensitivity only.

Output interpretation

- Low: limited claim-risk signal in the text reviewed, but evidence files should still be retained for material claims.
- Medium: potentially broad, sensitive or under-substantiated wording; claim-owner review recommended before reuse.
- High: broad or sensitive wording plus evidence gaps and/or relevant public-source contradiction signals; legal/compliance or senior review recommended.
- No clear signal: the crawler did not retain a material claim signal. This may also mean the selected page contains little relevant claim wording.

Key limitations

- The tool depends on crawler access and may miss blocked pages, PDFs, images, paywalled material or dynamic content.
- External-source signals are not findings; they are leads for manual verification.
- The tool does not replace legal review, EmpCo compliance assessment, CSRD/ESRS assurance, product substantiation review or forced-labour compliance work.
- The same wording can carry a different risk depending on audience and context; this is why the v34 channel distinction is included.